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Lin Ren is a Ph.D. student at the School of Computer Science and Engineering, Southeast University, China, advised by Prof. [Guohui Xiao](#) and Prof. [Guilin Qi](#). His primary research interest is *Knowledge Representation and Reasoning* (KRR), with contributions from knowledge graphs, natural language processing, and large language models. A particular emphasis is on *Virtual Knowledge Graphs* (VKGs), also known as *Ontology-based Data Access* (OBDA).

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Knowledge Representation and Reasoning (KRR)
- Virtual Knowledge Graphs, Ontology-based Data Access (OBDA)
- Answer Set Programming (ASP)
- Large Language Models
- Causal Inference
- Information Extraction

EDUCATION

Sept 2024 - present, Ph.D. student in Software Engineering

Southeast University, Nanjing, China

School of Computer Science and Engineering

advisors Prof. [Guohui Xiao](#) and Prof. [Guilin Qi](#)

June 2024, Master of Electronic Information

University of South China, Hengyang, Hunan, China

School of Computer Science and Technology

advisors Prof. [Yongbin Liu](#) and Prof. [Chunping Ouyang](#)

thesis "Research on Debiasing Knowledge Graphs based on Causal Inference" (in Chinese)

June 2021, Bachelor of Engineering in Software Engineering

University of South China, Hengyang, Hunan, China

School of Computer Science and Technology

thesis "Causal Relation Extraction from Financial Text" (in Chinese)

PUBLICATIONS

My name is in bold. Titles link to the paper where a public version is available.

2026

[EvoThink: Evolving Thinking in Large Reasoning Models via Self-Pruning and Aha-Moment Preference Optimization](#)

Dai, X., Xin, Z., Hu, H., **Ren, L.**, Jin, R., Xiao, G., Qi, G., Dong, K., Du, Z., and Zhang, Y.

Proceedings of the International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI-26)

[NaVQA: Mitigating Silent Failures in Question Answering over Virtual Knowledge Graph](#)

Xiao, G., Xue, H., **Ren, L.**, Geng, Y., Qi, G., Zhang, S., Guo, D., Di Panfilo, M., Lanti, D., and Ding, L.

Proceedings of the International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI-26)

Information-Needs-Guided Virtual Knowledge Graph Enrichment via Large Language Models
Ren, L., Xiao, G., Qi, G., Du, W., Geng, Y., Xue, H., Yue, Z., Li, M., Di Panfilo, M., Lanti, D., Hamaz, K., and Ding, L.

Proceedings of the International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI-26)

Code as Representation: A Compilable Parsing Paradigm for Academic Documents

Jin, R., Wang, J., Liang, M., Gao, Y., Li, Y., Dong, K., Qi, G., **Ren, L.**, Chen, Y., Dai, X., Li, J., Wu, T., and Haffari, G.

ACM International Conference on Multimedia (ACM MM 2026)

2025

LLM4VKG: Leveraging Large Language Models for Virtual Knowledge Graph Construction

| [code](#)

Xiao, G., **Ren, L.**, Qi, G., Xue, H., Panfilo, M. D., and Lanti, D.

Proceedings of the 34th International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI-25)

DyLas: A dynamic label alignment strategy for large-scale multi-label text classification | [code](#)

Ren, L., Liu, Y., Ouyang, C., Yu, Y., Zhou, S., He, Y., and Wan, Y.

Information Fusion, 120, 103081

Can LLMs Solve ASP Problems? Insights from a Benchmarking Study

Ren, L., Xiao, G., Qi, G., Geng, Y., and Xue, H.

International Conference on Principles of Knowledge Representation and Reasoning (KR 2025)

2024

Multimodal emotion recognition based on hierarchical fusion strategy and contextual information embedding

Minglong, S., Chunping, O., Yongbin, L., and **Lin, R.**

Beijing Da Xue Xue Bao, 60(3), 393-402

2023

CoVariance-based causal debiasing for entity and relation extraction | [code](#)

Ren, L., Liu, Y., Cao, Y., and Ouyang, C.

Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2023, 2627-2640

Causal inference-based debiasing framework for knowledge graph completion | [code](#)

Ren, L., Liu, Y., and Ouyang, C.

International Semantic Web Conference (ISWC 2023), 328-347. Cham: Springer Nature Switzerland

Counterfactual can be strong in medical question and answering

Yang, Z., Liu, Y., Ouyang, C., **Ren, L.**, and Wen, W.

Information Processing & Management, 60(4), 103408

Joint span and token framework for few-shot named entity recognition

Fang, W., Liu, Y., Ouyang, C., **Ren, L.**, Li, J., and Wan, Y.

AI Open, 4, 111-119